

Sprint Retrospective – Sprint 3

CampusBites

Sprint Goal

The goal of Sprint 3 was to finalize the major functionality of CampusBites by implementing payment workflows, analytics, order-management improvements, authentication refinements, and presentation-ready usability enhancements while preparing the platform for final submission.

1. What Went Well

Major Functional Progress

The team successfully completed and refined several important platform features, including:

- Cash-payment workflow
- Vendor order-history system
- Admin analytics
- Email verification
- Recommended vendors functionality
- Multi-vendor discovery page
- Improved role-based navigation
- Vendor/customer profile refinements
- PWA support and deployment readiness

The system became significantly more complete and presentation-ready compared to earlier sprints.

Improved UI & Navigation

The team made major improvements to:

- Navigation consistency
- Mobile responsiveness
- Homepage design

- Vendor discoverability
- Branding and UI polish

The redesigned navigation bar and profile-dropdown system helped modernize the overall user experience and reduced clutter across pages.

External Feedback (“The Bomb”)

The team benefited significantly from external usability feedback provided by an unbiased tester referred to as “The Bomb.”

This feedback helped identify several overlooked usability issues, including:

- Cart feedback problems
- Vendor discoverability issues
- Cluttered order-management pages
- Missing notifications
- Navigation inconsistencies
- UI polish concerns

The team used this feedback to prioritize refinements and improve the user experience before final submission.

Collaboration & Communication

Team members consistently:

- Reviewed and merged PRs
- Assisted each other with debugging/testing
- Coordinated feature integration
- Shared deployment/testing responsibilities

Despite overlapping workloads, communication remained active throughout the sprint.

2. Challenges Faced

Payment Integration Complexity

Payment integration created several difficulties:

- Hosted-domain restrictions
- Deployment inconsistencies
- Testing limitations on GitHub Pages
- Refund/payment-confirmation workflows

The team had to rely heavily on the Vercel deployment for successful payment testing.

Merge Conflicts & Shared Files

Multiple members worked on:

- Navigation
- Browse pages
- Dashboard layouts
- Shared CSS/UI components

This frequently caused:

- Merge conflicts
- Pull-request delays
- Integration issues

The team later improved coordination by reviewing PRs more frequently and communicating changes earlier.

Testing Difficulties

The team struggled with:

- Jest test creation
- Firebase testing
- Maintaining code coverage
- Updating tests after UI changes

Testing often became time-consuming because functionality evolved rapidly during the sprint.

Academic Workload

Several members experienced pressure from:

- University tests
- Assignments
- Project deadlines from other modules

This occasionally affected meeting attendance, development pace, and review turnaround times.

3. What Could Be Improved

Earlier UI Standardization

The team realized:

- Shared CSS styling
- Navigation consistency
- Branding standards

should have been established earlier in development to reduce repetitive refinement work later.

Earlier External Testing

“The Bomb” feedback proved extremely valuable.

The team agreed that:

- External usability testing should have started earlier
 - More unbiased users could have been included
 - Earlier testing may have reduced late-stage refinement work
-

Better PR Coordination

The team identified the need for:

- Smaller PRs
- More frequent merges
- Better communication before editing shared files

This would help reduce merge conflicts and duplicated work.

4. Lessons Learned

Throughout Sprint 3, the team learned:

- Refinement and usability are just as important as core functionality
- External feedback is critical for identifying UX problems developers may overlook
- Consistent UI planning should happen early in development
- Shared-file coordination is essential in collaborative frontend projects
- Real-world deployment/testing often introduces problems not visible locally

The team also gained more experience with:

- Firebase integration
- Role-based systems
- Payment workflows
- Deployment management
- Agile collaboration and sprint planning

5. Final Reflection

Sprint 3 was considered highly successful overall. The team completed the majority of the platform's major functionality while significantly improving the professionalism, usability, and presentation quality of CampusBites.

Although the sprint introduced challenges involving payments, testing, merge conflicts, and time pressure, the team adapted well and continued improving the system through collaboration, refinement, and external feedback.